

TREE SHREWS

These small mammals look and behave like squirrels. They are active in the daytime and spend much of their time foraging for food on the ground.

Tree shrews are native to the tropical rainforests of Southeast Asia. They are unrelated to the true shrews and have their own order, Scandentia. Sharp claws on all their fingers and toes enable tree shrews to climb trees rapidly but, despite

their name, most of them are only partly arboreal. Their mixed diet includes insects, worms, fruits, and sometimes small mammals, reptiles, and birds.

Some tree shrews are solitary, while others live in pairs or groups. They are rapid breeders, raising their young in nests in tree crevices or on branches. The female pays her brood little attention, making only the occasional short visit to suckle them.

PHYLUM	CHORDATA
CLASS	MAMMALIA
ORDER	SCANDENTIA
FAMILIES	2
SPECIES	23

PEN-TAILED TREE SHREW

The family Ptilocercidae has only one member, the Southeast Asian pen-tailed tree shrew. The species is named for its long, feathery tail, which resembles a quill pen. This aids balance when climbing.



13–15 cm
5–6 in

PEN-TAILED TREE SHREW *Ptilocercus lowii*

This species has a rather spindly tail with a brushy tip, unlike most other tree shrews, which have a thick, bushy tail.

TREE SHREWS

Members of the family Tupaiidae have a long snout, which is used to locate insects and other invertebrates as well as fruits and leaves. Tree shrews also have sharp claws on all their fingers and toes, helping them to climb trees rapidly.

LARGE TREE SHREW *Tupaia tana*

Tree shrews are diurnal inhabitants of S.E. Asian forests. This species is found in Borneo and Sumatra and on nearby islands.



long snout

17–21 cm
6½–8½ in

elongated claws
help hold on to
tree branches

COLUGOS

The two species that form the order Dermoptera are gliding, rather than flying, mammals. They are found in the rainforests of Southeast Asia.

The colugos are distinguished by a furry membrane that stretches from the neck to the tips of the fingers and tail. When the limbs are splayed this membrane spreads out, allowing the lemur to manoeuvre in the air as it glides from

tree to tree. The distance covered in a glide may be more than 100 m (330 ft). Colugos live in the canopy, hanging upside down from branches or sheltering in cracks or hollow trees by day and emerging at night to feed on fruits and leaves. They are almost unable to move on the ground.

The teeth of colugos are unlike those of any other mammal. In the lower jaw, the teeth are arranged like combs and are believed to be used for grooming as well as for feeding.

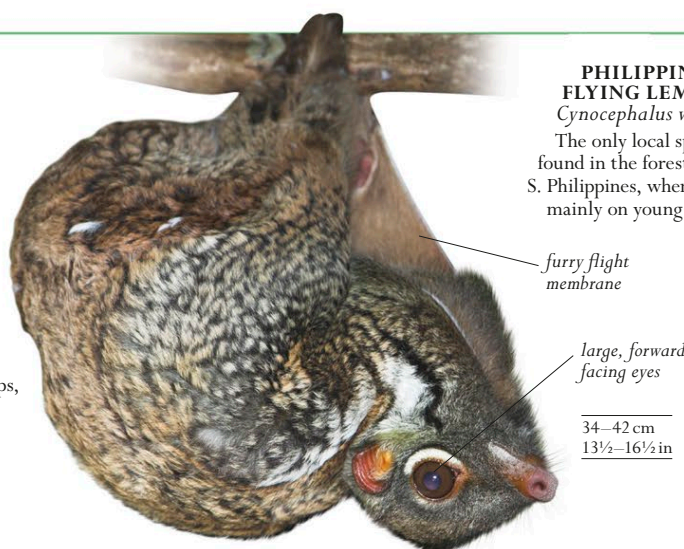
PHYLUM	CHORDATA
CLASS	MAMMALIA
ORDER	DERMOPTERA
FAMILIES	1
SPECIES	2

FLYING LEMURS

The two members of the Cynocephalidae have forward-facing eyes that provide depth perception. This helps them judge distances when gliding from tree to tree. They also have unusual comb-like lower teeth, used to strain food such as fruits and flowers.

SUNDA COLUGO *Cynocephalus variegatus*

This lemur lives alone or in small groups, inhabiting tree-holes or resting high on treetops in the tropical forests of S.E. Asia and the Indonesian islands.



furry flight
membrane

large, forward-
facing eyes

34–42 cm
13½–16½ in

PHILIPPINE FLYING LEMUR *Cynocephalus volans*

The only local species found in the forests of the S. Philippines, where it feeds mainly on young leaves.



34–42 cm
13½–16½ in